Deutsche Bank
Research

Q2 2026 Global Markets Survey

June 2026

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With special thanks to Anthony Chaimowitz from the dbDataInsights team

Deutsche Bank Research Institute

IMPORTANT RESEARCH DISCLOSURES LOCATED IN APPENDIX 1.

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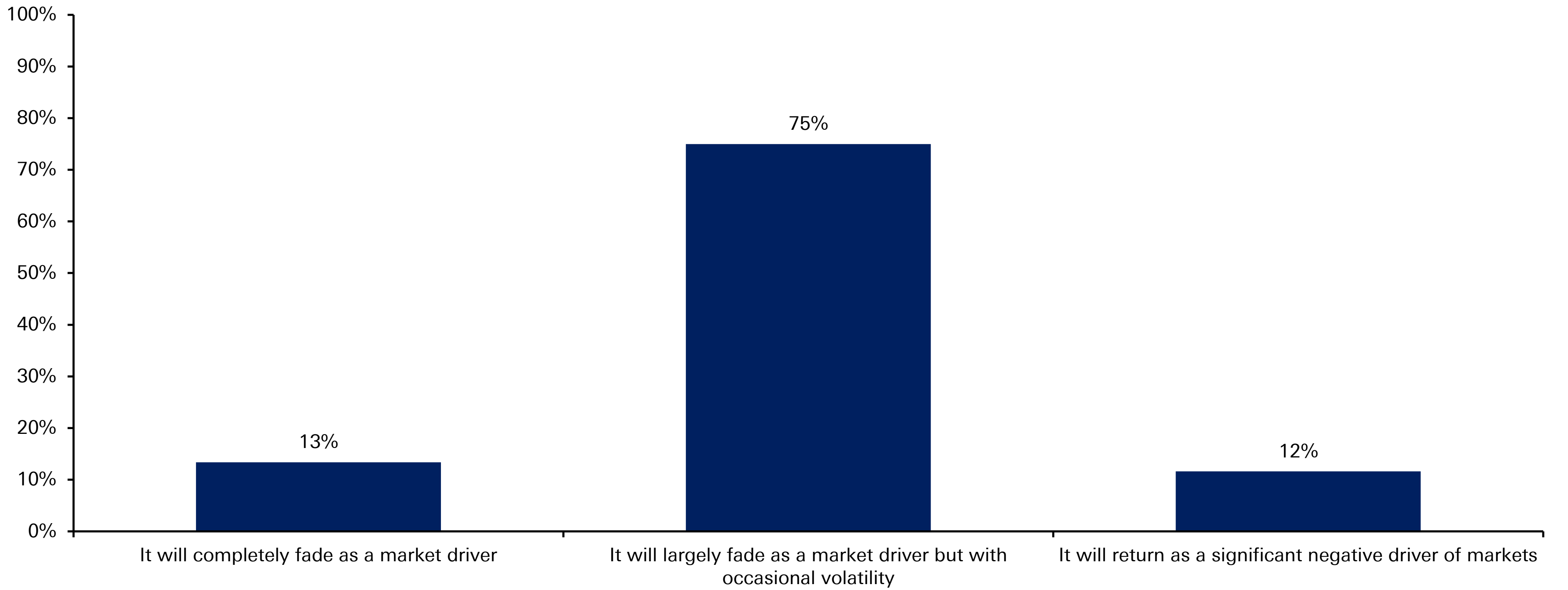
Our Q2 2026 global financial market survey had 275 responses from around the world, conducted between June 22nd and June 26th.

An overwhelming 75% believe the Iran conflict will now largely fade as a market driver into year-end, albeit with occasional volatility. With the 13% who think it will completely fade as a factor that makes 88% who are reasonably sanguine about events in the Middle East. Just 12% think it will return as a big negative driver.

When thinking about the Iran conflict, which of the following best reflects your view of its impact on financial markets for the rest of 2026?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

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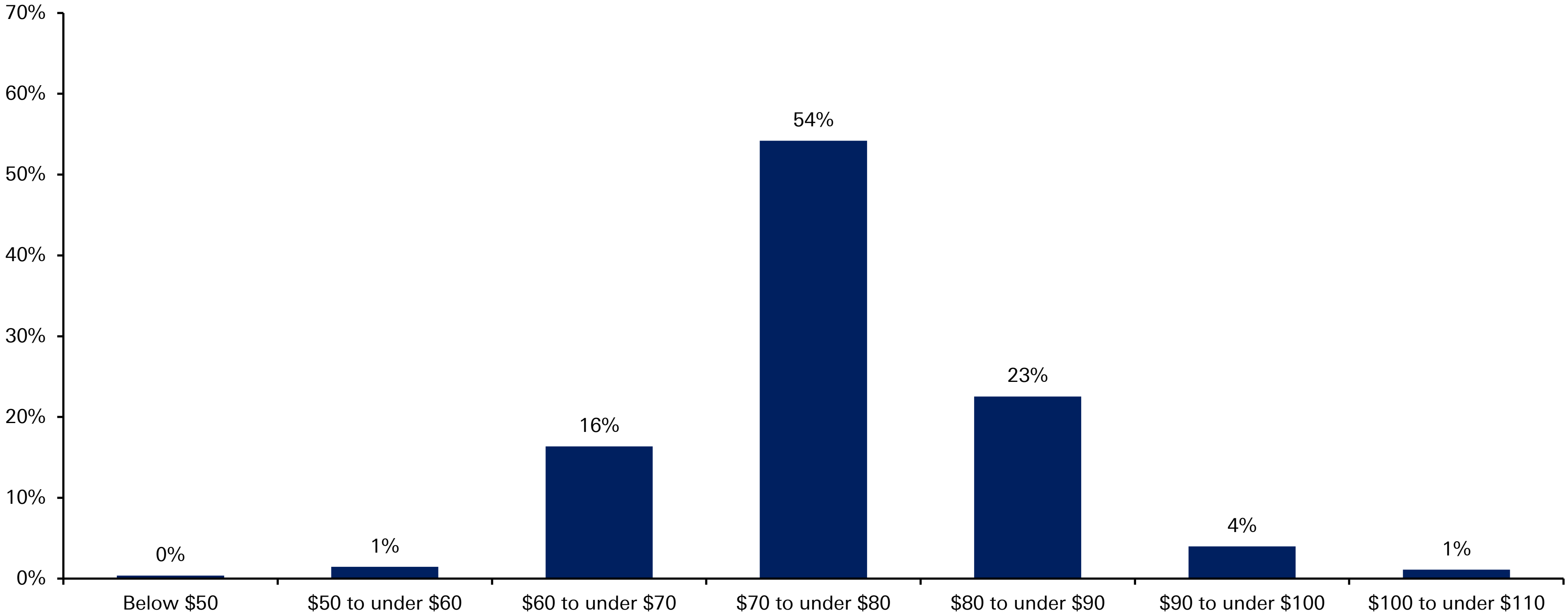
The more sanguine view on Iran has also led investors to dial down expectations of higher oil prices. A majority of respondents now think Brent will stay between $70-80/bbl for the remainder of the year. Compare that to April, when Brent peaked at ~$118/bbl.

Brent crude oil prices started the year at around $60, rose to approximately $70 prior to the Iran conflict, peaked near $120, and have since declined to around $80. With this in mind, where do you expect Brent crude prices to average for the remainder of the year?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

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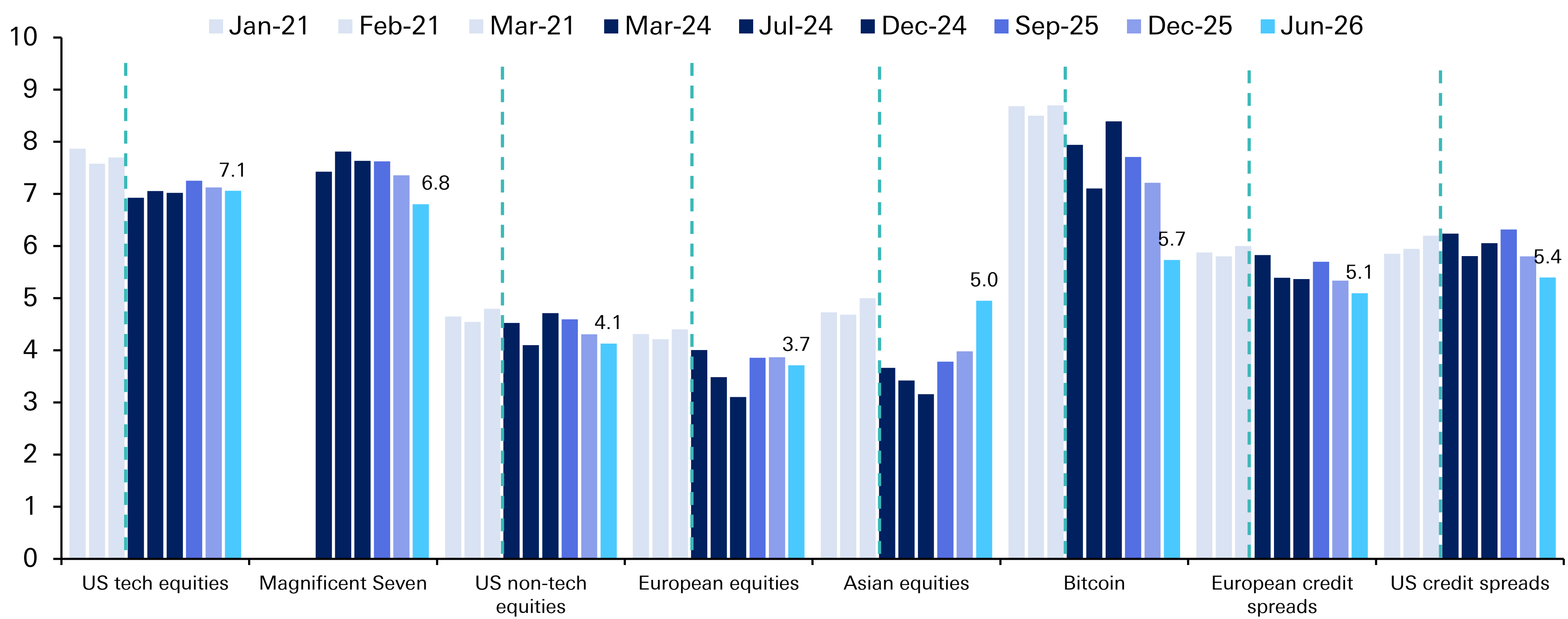
In our regular bubble question that we first asked in 2021, and then after a gap, in most quarters since 2024, we've seen the lowest perceived bubble risk for the Mag-7. Both US tech and Mag-7 still score around 7 out of 10 on our bubble risk scale, though. Note that Bitcoin bubble risk has collapsed to 5.7 after the near halving since last October.

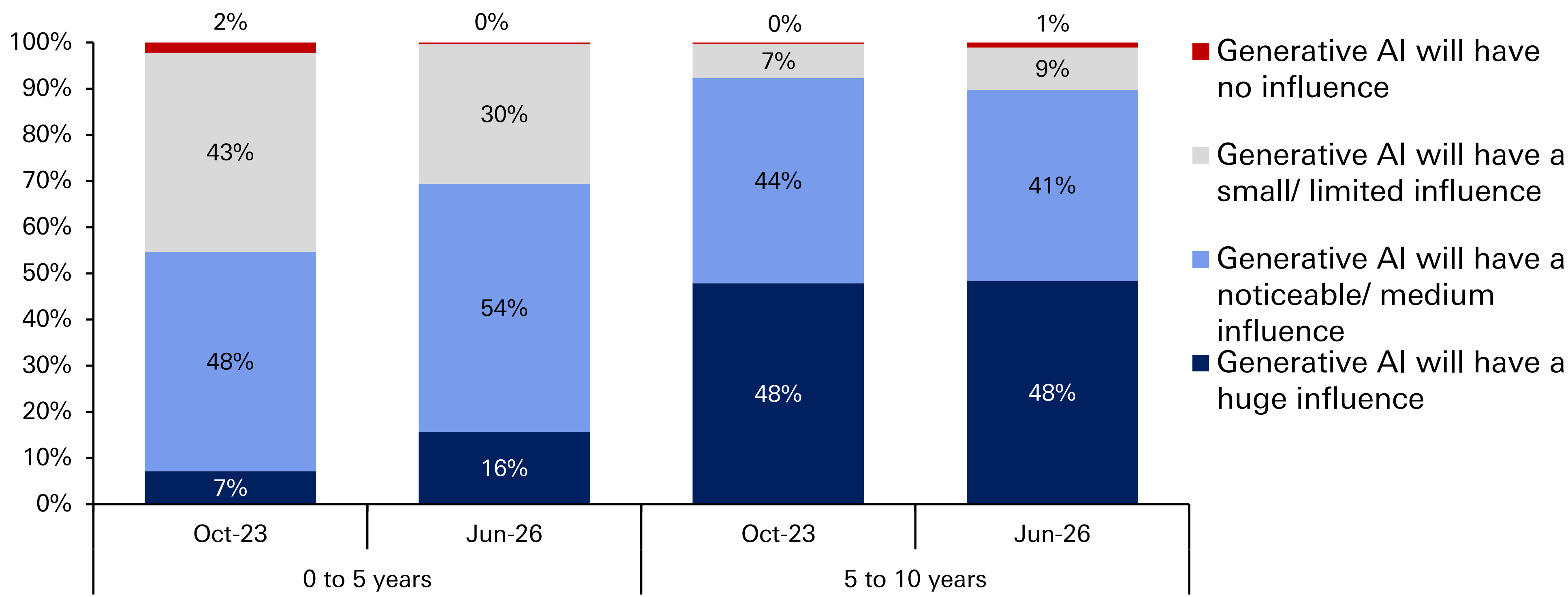
Looking at the following assets and using a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 means 'No Bubble' and 10 means 'Extreme Bubble', please tell us where you think these assets currently are.



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

We last asked about Gen AI's potential for productivity growth back in October 2023. Its expected near-term positive impact has increased since then – although some of that likely reflects the nearly 3 years of extra time since we last asked. Surprisingly, the anticipated 5- to 10-year impact has hardly changed, even if just under half still think it will have a huge impact on productivity.

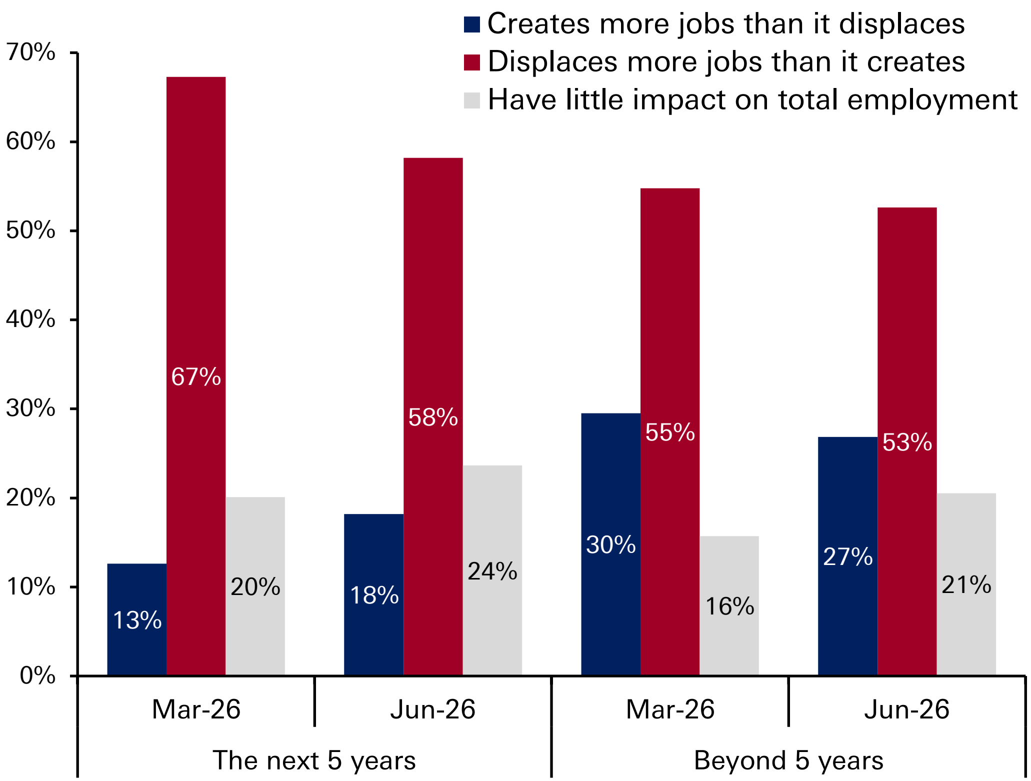
What influence, if any, do you think future iterations of Generative AI will have on productivity growth within the following time frames?

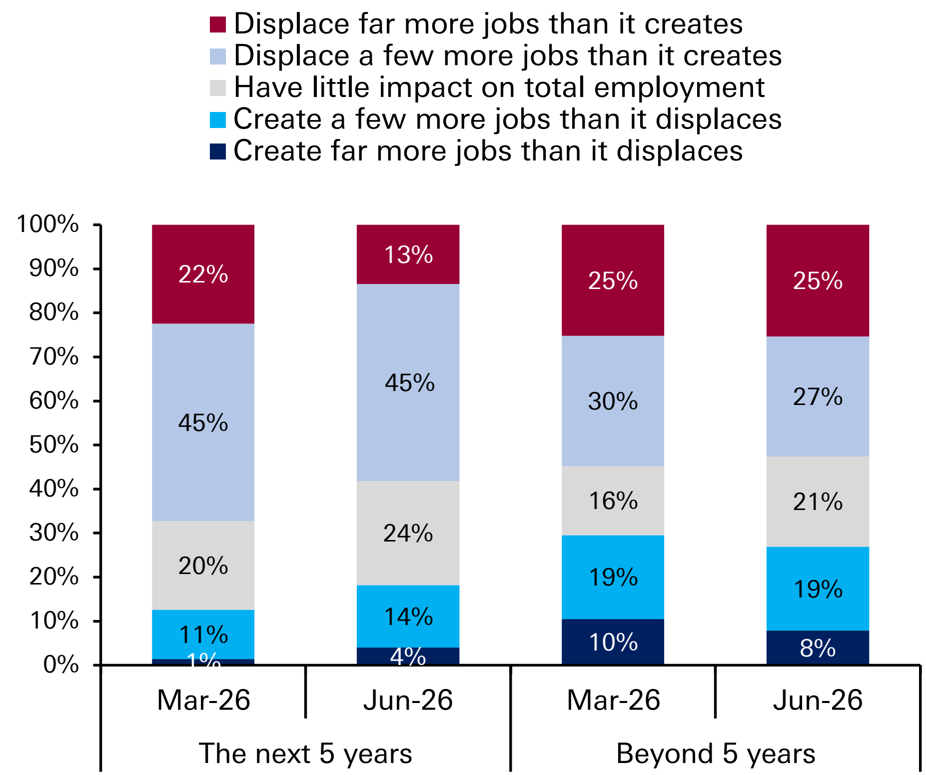


Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Market sentiment on AI's impact on jobs remains pessimistic, but we've seen a small improvement since we asked in March. The first chart aggregates the data into binary positive or negative, and the second breaks it down as to how positive or negative.

For the following time horizons, which best describes your expectation for AI's impact on employment? Assume a scenario where AI adoption stays on its current trajectory.

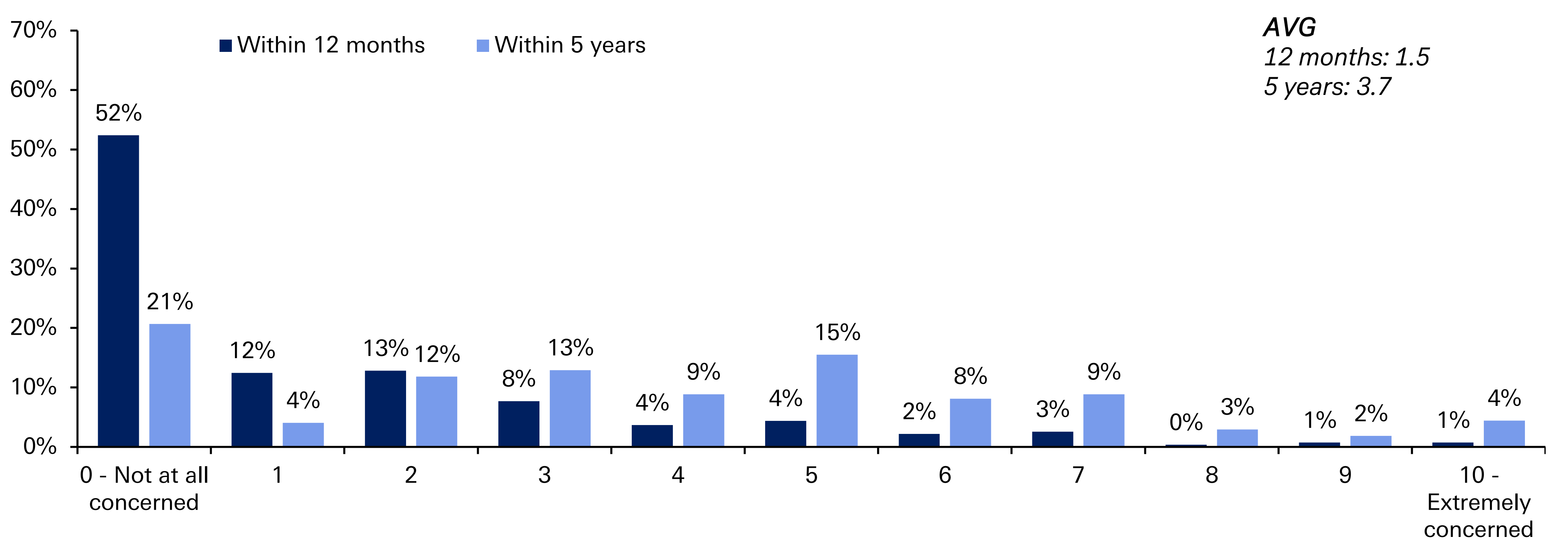




Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

52% say they are not concerned at all about their own jobs because of AI within the next 12 months. This drops to 21% within the next 5 years. The average scores (scale of 1-10) for these periods are 1.5 and 3.7, respectively. So, combining the last two charts suggests that people are more concerned about other people's jobs than their own due to AI.

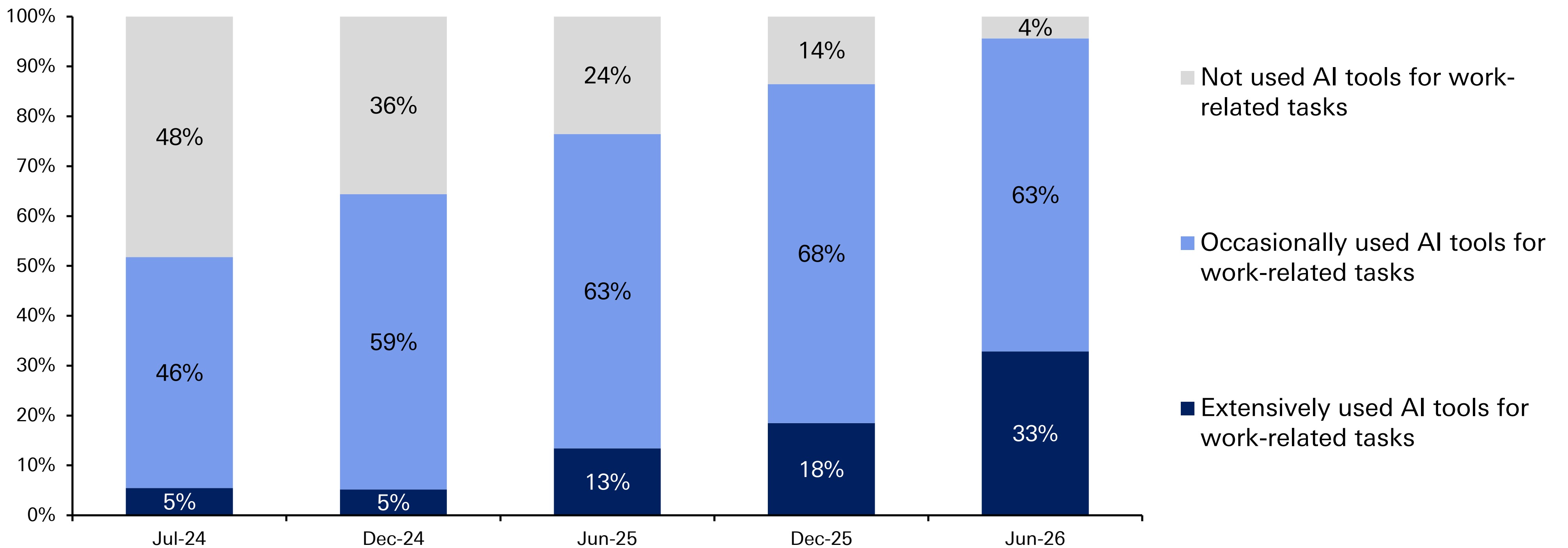
Using a scale of 0 to 10, where 0 is 'Not at all concerned' and 10 is 'Extremely concerned', how concerned are you that you will need to look for a new job within the following time frames because of AI?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Since March, AI adoption at work continues to accelerate as it has done steadily since we first asked 2 years ago. Now only 4% have not used AI for work, compared to 14% last December and 48% 2 years ago. "Extensively used" has also risen from 18% to 33% now since December – a pretty big increase.

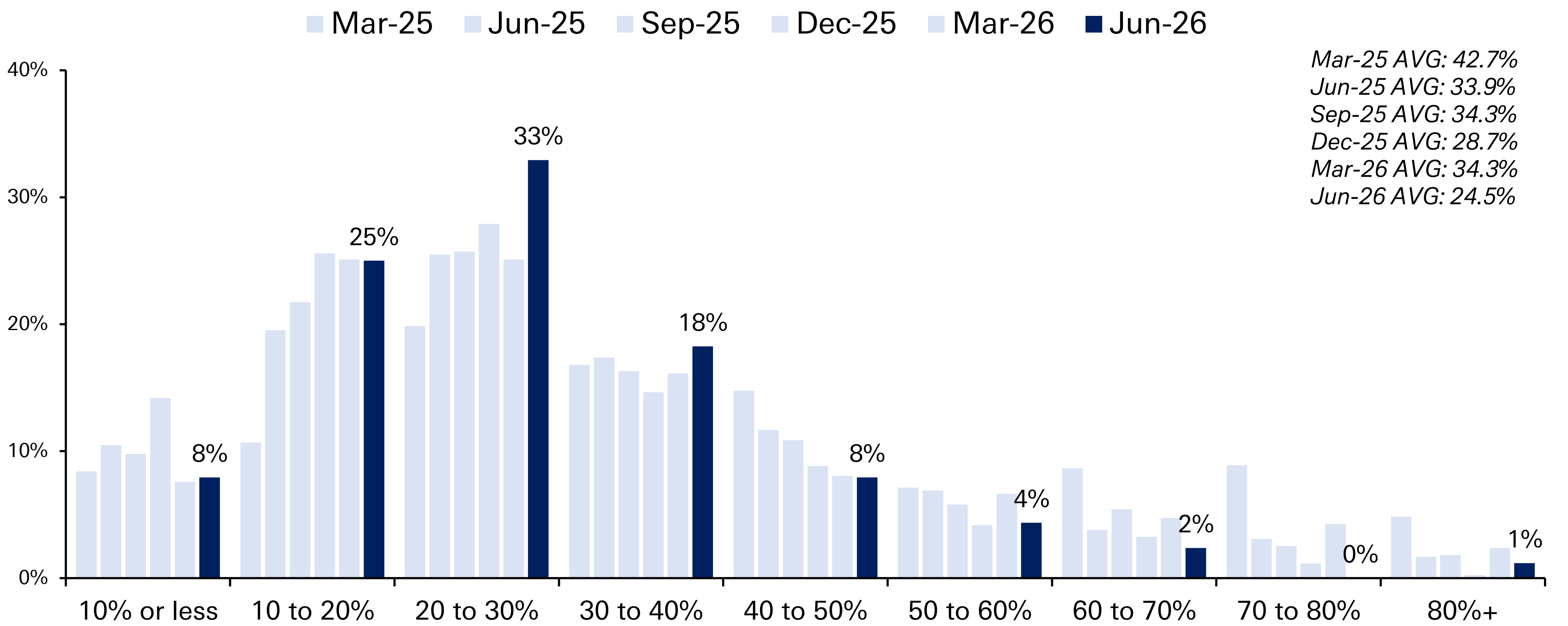
Which of the following best describes your use of AI tools for work-related tasks within the last three months?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Average perception of 12-month US recession risk is back down to 24.5%, its lowest score since we asked the question in this format last March. Back then it was 42.7% – and even this March, when the Iran War was in its early stages, it was 34.3%.

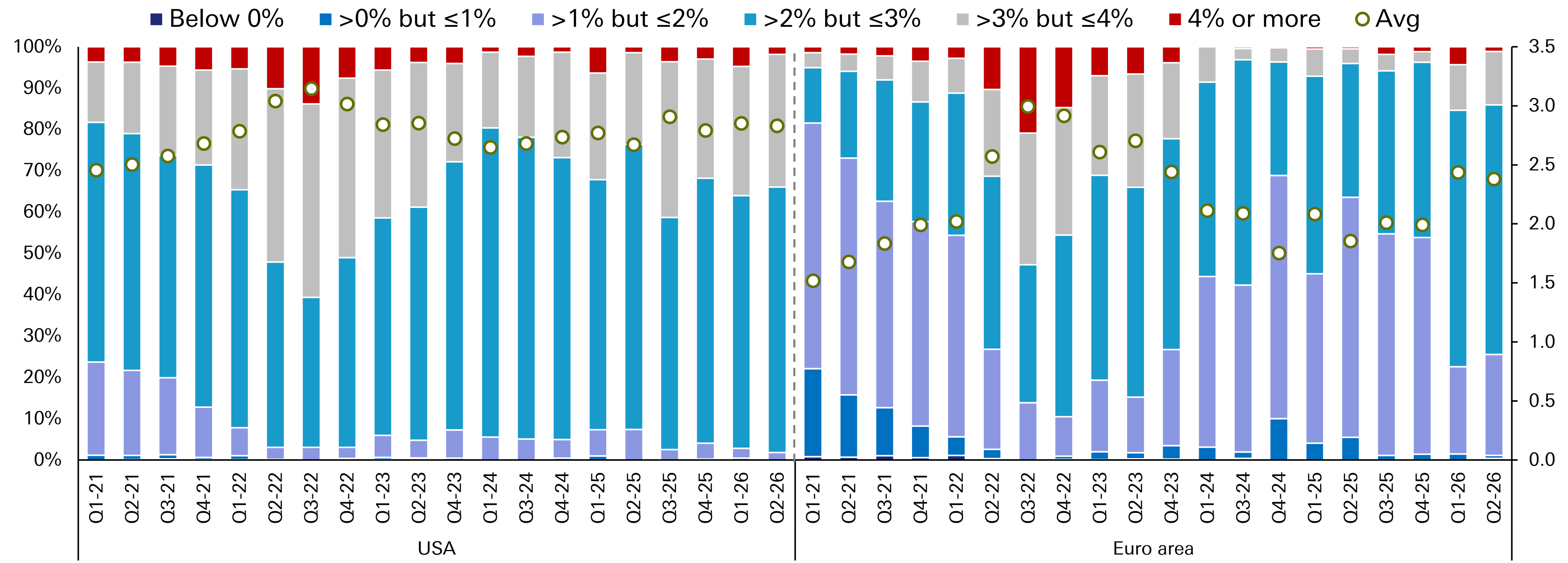
What do you think the probability of a US recession in the next 12 months is?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

Europe inflation expectations over the next 5 years are unchanged from March, at 2.4%. 5-year US inflation expectations have edged back down to 2.8% from 2.9% in March.

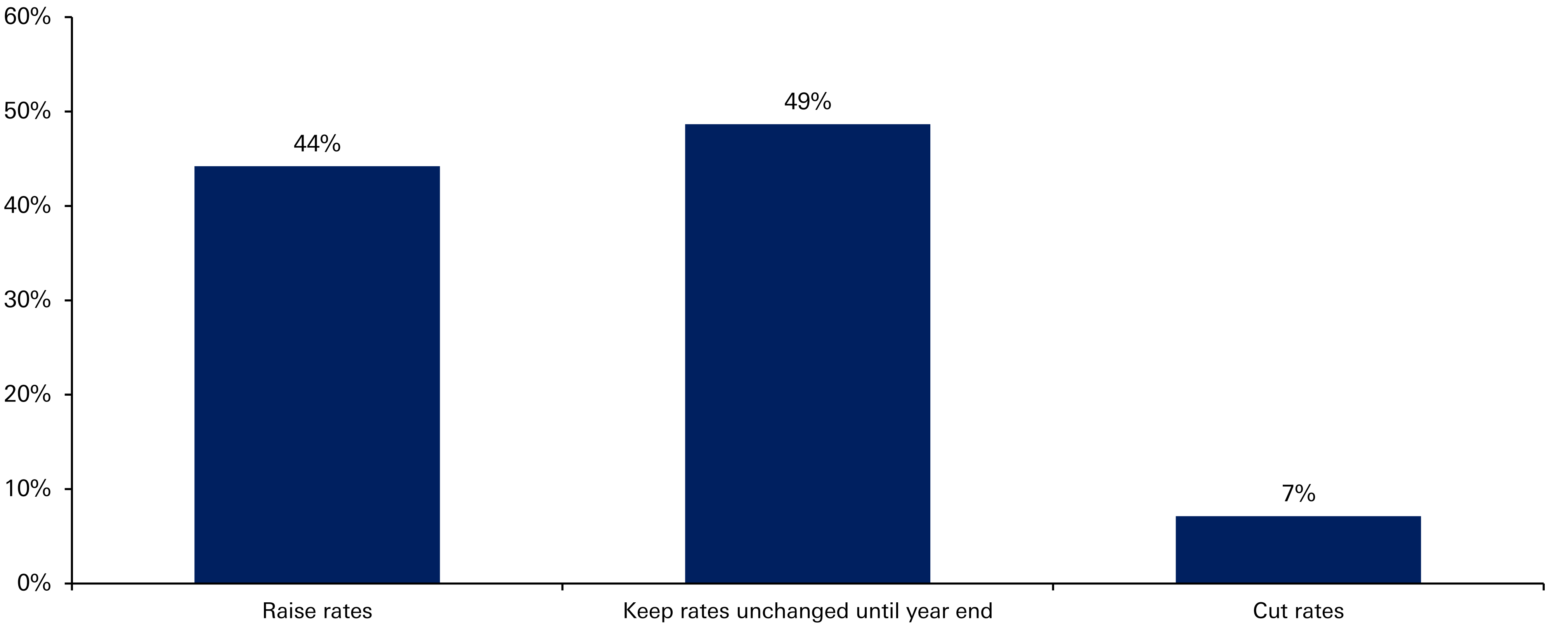
Looking at the below, what do you think inflation will average in the following regions over the next 5 years?



Source: dbDataInsights Survey, Deutsche Bank Research

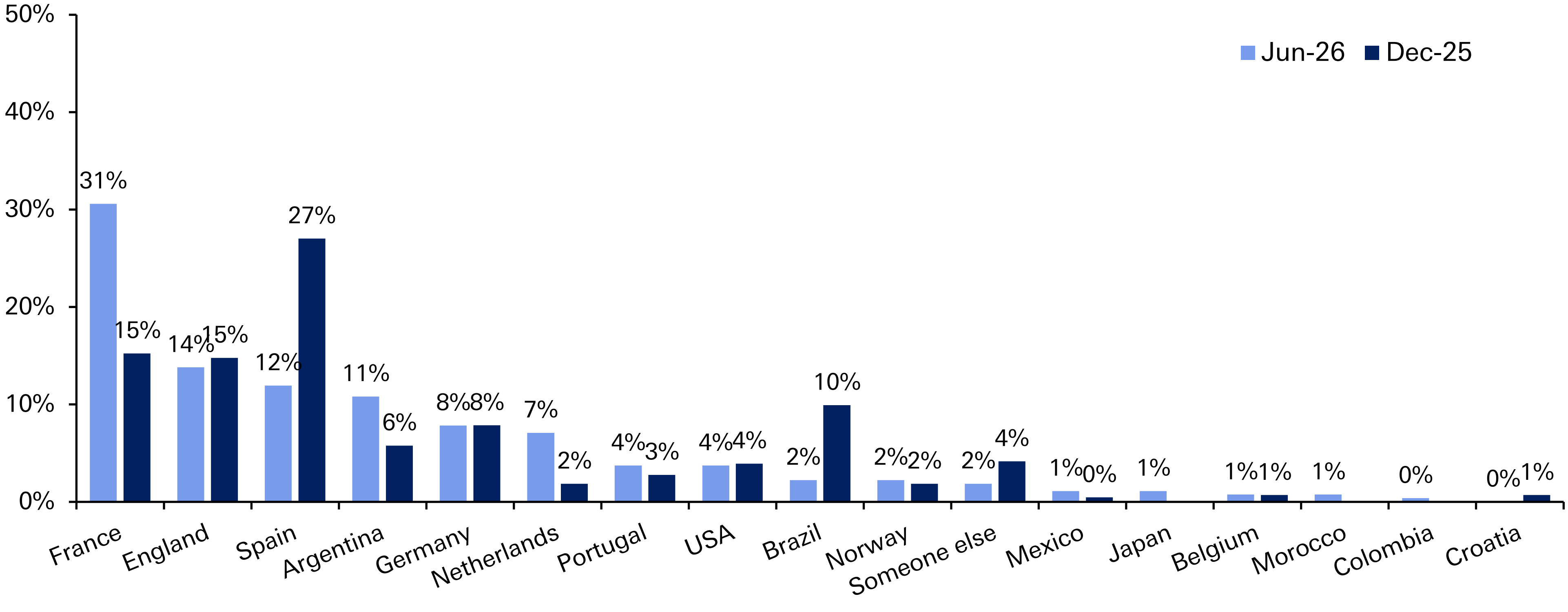
Markets are pricing in almost one-and-a-half hikes by December. Yet perhaps the receding threat of an oil-driven shock has made our respondents lean slightly more dovish, with 49% thinking the Fed will stay on hold this year and 7% thinking cuts are still on the agenda. 44% think a hike is coming.

What do you think the Fed's next move will be in 2026?



And finally, a majority (31%) think France will win the World Cup this year, followed by England (14%). Spain and Brazil have seen the biggest shifts in opinion since December.

Who do you think will win the 2026 football World Cup?



Appendix 1

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